Evgenii (Eugene) Baianov

Senior Backend Engineer (Go/PHP) · AI/LLM Product Engineer
Phuket, Thailand (UTC+7) · Remote (contractor or EOR) · bayanovea@gmail.com · Telegram @bayanovea · linkedin.com/in/evgenii-baianov · github.com/bayanovea

SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 13 years on high-traffic web products, most recently at VK Video and Skyeng; five of them as a team lead and tech lead. Writes Go now, after years of PHP.

Works with coding agents daily and builds the tooling around them: agent instructions, skills, hooks, MCP, spec-driven workflow (OpenSpec). Ships LLM features and measures whether they work; latest project: an LLM ad-segment detector for my own browser extension with ~11k weekly active users, scored by a public eval harness. Looking for a hands-on senior engineering role, ideally building products around LLMs.

EXPERIENCE

VK · VK Video, creator platform — Team Lead · May 2024 – Sep 2026

Led the backend of two product teams in the creator area (~7 engineers) of VK Video, a platform with 40M+ daily users and ~3B video views a day (2025): content creation (upload, publish, manage videos) and the creator channel (channel page, customization, subscriptions). Clients: iOS, Android, web, TV, open API.

- Owned features from design to production; e.g. "comment as a channel" (designed and built the backend): A/B result: +14% creators commenting on web and +23% comments per creator on Android.
- Led the team's part of the KPHP → Go migration: designed the creator-channel service, took it through architecture review, and worked on the migration alongside the team; by the end most of the team's API methods ran in Go.
- Owned the area's product stability: every feature shipped behind toggles with a gradual rollout and an A/B test on product metrics (watch time, subscriptions, creator retention) before full launch; incident response.
- Over the period, the platform's creator base grew about 6x, video uploads 4.6x and total watch time 2.1x in 2025 alone; in the area our two teams owned, creator MAU grew 20–107% every half-year, channel subscriptions x3.2 and upload-to-publish conversion +7 pts in H2 2025.
- Planning and coordination with other teams, delivery processes (per-epic PRDs, early decomposition), hiring and performance reviews; delivery predictability ~92%.

Skyeng — Team Lead, internal automation · Apr 2023 – May 2024

- Led the internal-automation team (~7 engineers): all shared internal tools and integrations for a fully remote company of ~1,400 employees.
- Owned the CMDB (PHP): system of record for users, teams, services and servers; permissions and per-team infrastructure costs.
- Owned the company messenger (Go): operations, plugins, integrations and internal bots; ran two company-wide migrations (Slack → Mattermost → TiMe).
- Owned Jira and Confluence (Groovy/ScriptRunner): rollout, performance tuning, monitoring and administration; built automations on top of them for other teams.

VK · VK Video — Senior Backend Developer (PHP/KPHP) · Jun 2022 – Apr 2023

- Built and optimized video, clips and live-stream features at ~2B daily views.

Skyeng — three roles · Nov 2018 – Apr 2022

- **Senior Backend Developer, Skysmart** (2020–2022): launched several products under tight deadlines; designed their new backend architecture.
- **Unit Lead, Platform unit** (2019–2020): led 8 platform teams through their team leads; introduced SLA/SLO/SLI in all of them; hired 3 team leads.
- **Team Lead, Billing team** (2018–2019): payments, balances and payouts; staffed the team with developers, QA and analysts.

Earlier · 2013 – 2018

- **Melon Fashion Group — Backend Developer (PHP)** (2017–2018): e-commerce for three fashion brands on Magento 2; peak-load preparation for sales; acting team lead.
- **uCoz — Backend Developer (PHP)** (2015–2017): backend in a cross-functional team of 6; chose the stack (Laravel/Lumen).
- **A-Position — Web Developer** (2013–2014): full-stack client sites, SQL optimization.

AI / LLM ENGINEERING

Native ad-segment detector + eval harness · Go, Anthropic API, OpenAI API

github.com/bayanovea/native-ad-skip-eval · github.com/bayanovea/native-ad-skip-api

Side project: my own browser extension, where viewers mark native ad segments in videos and others skip them; ~11k weekly active users, ~12.5k markups.

- Built the LLM detector and a public eval harness (a held-out set of 217 videos with human-reviewed labels). Result: 95% of what it cuts is real ad; about half of all ad time is removed.
- Decisions by measurement: compared Opus, Sonnet and Haiku on the same labels; cut inference cost 3x (Batches API, prompt format) with no measurable quality change; a Grafana dashboard tracks the live funnel and cost per video.
- Production loop: viewer reactions (votes, undos, new markups) feed an automatic re-check that withdraws a segment or sends it to human review.

AI-assisted engineering · Claude Code, Codex

github.com/bayanovea/claude-setup · github.com/bayanovea/agent-loop-go

- Early user and adopter of coding agents on a backend team: daily agent-driven development, coached engineers on where agents fit and where they don't.
- A controlled workflow, not vibe coding: spec-driven development (OpenSpec), plan before build, cross-review of each change by several models with different prompts; own agent setup public: github.com/bayanovea/claude-setup (layered agent instructions, skills, hooks).
- Per-task choice of model, harness and effort; knows where the tokens go: context budgeting, prompt caching, batch APIs.
- The machinery under the hood: how agent loops and tool use work (studied, and built a small one in Go), how coding-agent harnesses are designed and where they differ; working knowledge of RAG, prompt-injection defenses and guardrails, and when fine-tuning beats prompting.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Go (main), PHP (11+ years), SQL; some experience with Python, JavaScript, Node.js.
- **AI / LLM:** Anthropic and OpenAI APIs (tool use, structured output, Batches API), prompt and context engineering, AI agents (agent loops, tool use), LLM evaluation: LLM-as-judge, eval harnesses (held-out sets, reviewed labels, run-to-run noise), staged rollout; Claude Code, Codex, Hermes; models: Claude, GPT, GLM, Kimi; agent instructions, skills, hooks, MCP (as a consumer); OpenSpec.
- **Data and infra:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, ClickHouse, Redis, Memcached, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch; gRPC, Kubernetes, Docker, GitLab CI, Grafana, Sentry.
- **Practices:** system and API design, high-traffic systems, A/B experiments, SLA/SLO/SLI, code review, hiring.

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

St. Petersburg State University, Specialist degree (5-year program) in Applied Mathematics and Informatics, 2014 · English: professional working proficiency · Russian: native